by having light porous and spongy bones that break very easily. Severe bone pain is reported which is relieved by immobilization. Fractures occur due to brittle bones.

11.2.3 Vitamin E

Vitamin E protects all cell membranes They are called as tocopherol. This word is derived from the Greek word 'tocos' meaning child birth, and 'phenos' meaning to bear and 'ol' meaning alcohol. The vitamin is stored in all the tissues and the tissue stores can provide protection against the deficiency for long periods.

Functions

- Vitamin E is an important antioxidant.
- Promotes normal growth and development
- Promotes normal red blood cell formation
- Acts as anti blood clotting agent
- helps in absorption of vitamin A and vitamin C.
- Vitamin E dilates the capillaries and enables the blood to flow freely into the muscle tissue, thus strengthening both the tissues and the nerves supplying them.
- reduces the risk of heart diseases.

Food Sources of Vitamin E

The principle source of vitamin E is vegetable oils Eg- Corn, and peanut oil. Nuts and seeds Eg - Almonds, hazelnuts, sunflower seeds, safflower, soya bean oil and walnuts. Margarine, meat and fish, whole grains, wheat germ, spinach, lettuce, dark green leafy vegetables, black berries, apple, pears, legumes, eggs and milk are good sources of vitamin E. Human milk has more vitamin E than cow's milk and is sufficient for infants.

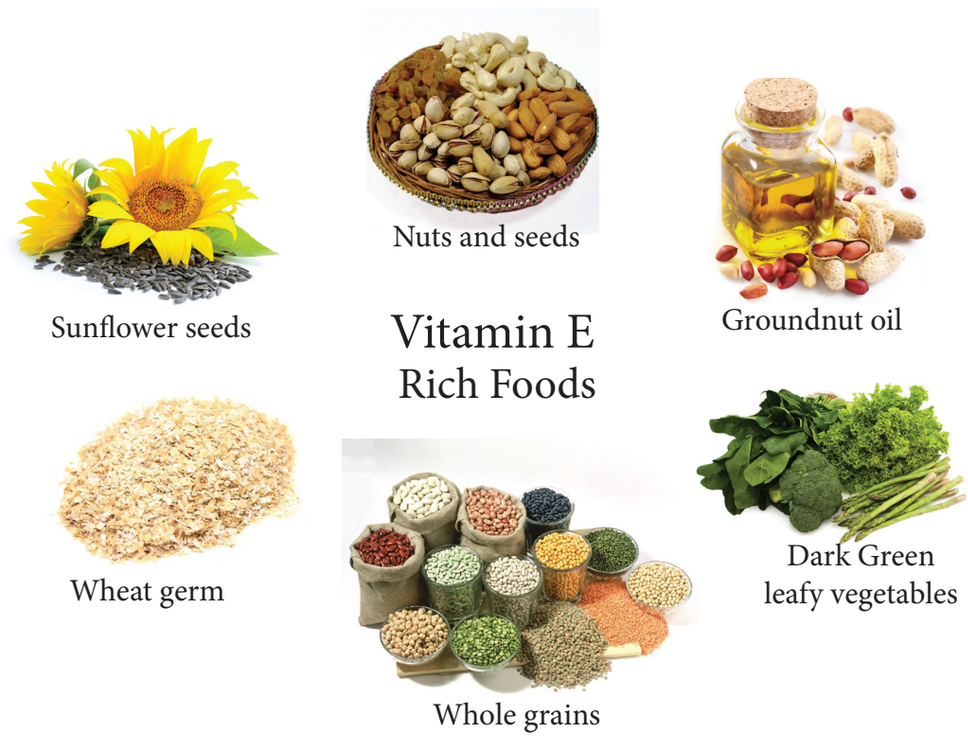


Fig 11.5: Food Sources of Vitamin E

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